

NotiFetch

Google Play Store Submission Guide

Version 2.1.0

versionCode: 3 | versionName: 2.1.0

Delivery Driver Notification Aggregator

Application ID: com.notifetch.app

SHA-256:

81:97:95:57:6B:2F:1C:94:D2:7A:6B:63:E2:3C:7C:C7:D8:58:50:CB:CA:A1:E5:00:7A:23:BB:3B:44:DD:AB:FE

Web: <https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app>

Privacy: <https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/privacy>

Terms: <https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/terms>

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1. Pre-Submission Checklist

Before submitting NotiFetch to the Google Play Store, every item in this checklist must be completed. Google Play enforces strict policies on notification access apps, data safety declarations, and legal compliance. Missing any item below may result in app rejection or suspension. Each item is marked with its priority level and the section of this guide where detailed instructions can be found.

Item	Status	Priority	Section
Firebase project created + google-services.json	PENDING	CRITICAL	Section 2
Keystore passwords saved securely	PENDING	CRITICAL	Section 3
Signed AAB generated	PENDING	CRITICAL	Section 3
Google Play Developer account	PENDING	CRITICAL	Section 4
Privacy Policy URL live	LIVE	CRITICAL	Section 7
Terms of Service URL live	LIVE	CRITICAL	Section 7
Data Safety form completed	PENDING	HIGH	Section 6
Content Rating questionnaire	PENDING	HIGH	Section 6
Store listing content prepared	PENDING	HIGH	Section 5
App screenshots captured	PENDING	MEDIUM	Section 5
Feature graphic designed	PENDING	MEDIUM	Section 5

Items marked CRITICAL will block your submission entirely. Items marked HIGH may cause rejection during Google Play review. Items marked MEDIUM are recommended but may not block initial submission. Note that Privacy Policy and Terms of Service URLs are already live on your Vercel deployment, which satisfies two of the most common rejection reasons for notification-access apps.

2. Firebase Project Setup

NotiFetch uses Firebase for three features: Anonymous Authentication (for cross-device sync), Firebase Cloud Messaging (for push notifications), and Firebase Analytics (for usage insights). Currently, the google-services.json in the Android project is a placeholder and must be replaced with a real Firebase project configuration. The core notification listener feature works without Firebase, but cloud sync, push notifications, and analytics require proper Firebase setup.

2.1 Create Firebase Project

Follow these exact steps to set up Firebase for NotiFetch:

- Step 1.** Go to <https://console.firebase.google.com> and sign in with your Google account
- Step 2.** Click 'Add Project' and enter the project name: **NotiFetch**
- Step 3.** Disable Google Analytics for now (you can enable it later) and click Create Project
- Step 4.** Once created, click the Android icon to add an Android app
- Step 5.** Enter the Android package name: **com.notifetch.app**
- Step 6.** Enter the app nickname: **NotiFetch**
- Step 7.** Enter the SHA-1 and SHA-256 fingerprints from your keystore
- Step 8.** Click 'Register App'
- Step 9.** Download the **google-services.json** file
- Step 10.** Replace the placeholder file at: `notifetch-android/app/google-services.json`
- Step 11.** Continue through the remaining setup steps (add Firebase SDK - already configured in `build.gradle.kts`)

2.2 Add SHA-256 Fingerprint to Firebase

Your keystore SHA-256 fingerprint must be added to the Firebase project for Authentication and Dynamic Links to work. This fingerprint is already generated and stored in your signing credentials:

```
SHA-256: 81:97:95:57:6B:2F:1C:94:D2:7A:6B:63:E2:3C:7C:C7:D8:58:50:CB:CA:A1:E5:00:7A:23:BB:3B:44:DD:AB:FE
```

To add it in Firebase Console: Go to Project Settings > Your Apps > NotiFetch > SHA certificate fingerprints > Add fingerprint. Paste the SHA-256 value above. This must match the keystore you use to sign the AAB, or Firebase Auth will reject all sign-in attempts.

2.3 Enable Firebase Services

Service	Firebase Console Path	Required
Anonymous Auth	Authentication > Sign-in method > Anonymous	Yes
Cloud Messaging	Project Settings > Cloud Messaging	Yes
Analytics	Analytics (enable in Project Settings)	Recommended
Crashlytics	Crashlytics (enable in sidebar)	Recommended

2.4 Download and Replace google-services.json

After registering the Android app in Firebase, download the google-services.json file and place it at the following path in your Android project, replacing the placeholder:

```
notifetch-android/app/google-services.json
```

The placeholder file currently contains dummy values (project_id: notifetch-placeholder, api_key: PLACEHOLDER_API_KEY). The Google Services Gradle plugin will validate this file during build, and a real Firebase config is required for Authentication and FCM to function. After replacing the file, sync your Gradle project in Android Studio before building.

3. Building the Signed AAB

Google Play Store requires an Android App Bundle (AAB) file for new app submissions. The AAB contains compiled code and resources for all device configurations, and Google Play uses it to generate optimized APKs for each user device. The AAB must be signed with your release keystore. Your project is already configured with a release signing configuration in build.gradle.kts, but you need to set the keystore passwords before building.

3.1 Keystore Configuration

Property	Value
Keystore Path	twu/keystore.jks (relative to project root)
Key Alias	notifetch
SHA-256	81:97:95:57:6B:2F:1C:94:D2:7A:6B:63:E2:3C:7C:C7:D8:58:50:CB:CA:A1:E5:00:7A:23:BB:3B:44:DD:AB:FE
Store Password	Set via NOTIFETCH_STORE_PASSWORD env var
Key Password	Set via NOTIFETCH_KEY_PASSWORD env var

The signing configuration in build.gradle.kts reads passwords from environment variables NOTIFETCH_STORE_PASSWORD and NOTIFETCH_KEY_PASSWORD. If these are not set, the build falls back to the hardcoded value 'changeme_notifetch_store_2024'. You must ensure the passwords you set match those used when generating the keystore, or the build will fail with a keystore tampering error.

3.2 Build Commands

Open a terminal in the notifetch-android directory and run the following commands to generate the signed AAB. Make sure you have Android Studio or the Android SDK command-line tools installed, and that ANDROID_HOME is set to your SDK path.

```
# Option 1: Set passwords as environment variables (RECOMMENDED)
export NOTIFETCH_STORE_PASSWORD=your_store_password
export NOTIFETCH_KEY_PASSWORD=your_key_password

# Build the release AAB
cd notifetch-android
./gradlew bundleRelease

# The AAB will be generated at:
# app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab

# Option 2: Build from Android Studio
# 1. Open the notifetch-android project in Android Studio
# 2. Go to Build > Generate Signed Bundle / APK
# 3. Select 'Android App Bundle'
# 4. Choose the keystore at twa/keystore.jks
# 5. Enter the key alias: notifetch
# 6. Enter the store and key passwords
# 7. Select 'release' build variant
# 8. Click Finish
```

3.3 Verify the AAB

After building, verify the AAB file before uploading to Play Store. Check that the file size is reasonable (typically 3-8 MB for a Compose app), the signing certificate matches your keystore, and the version information is correct:

```
# Check AAB file size
ls -la app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab

# Verify signing certificate matches
# The SHA-256 should match: 81:97:95:57:6B:2F:1C:94:D2:7A:6B:63:...
keytool -printcert -jarfile app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab

# Check bundle contents
bundletool dump manifest --bundle=app-release.aab
```

4. Google Play Console Setup

4.1 Create Developer Account

To publish apps on Google Play, you need a Google Play Developer account. This is a one-time registration that costs \$25 USD. Go to <https://play.google.com/console/signup> and follow the registration process. You will need a Google account, identity verification (government ID), and a credit card for the registration fee. The verification process typically takes 1-3 business days, though it can be faster. Once registered, you will have access to the Google Play Console where you can create and manage your app listings.

4.2 Create App Listing

Once your developer account is active, create a new app listing in Google Play Console. Follow these steps carefully, as some fields cannot be changed after the first release:

Step 1: Click 'Create app' in the Play Console dashboard

Step 2: App name: **NotiFetch**

Step 3: Default language: **English (United States)**

Step 4: Free or paid: **Free**

Step 5: App declarations: Accept the Play App Signing Terms, US export laws compliance

Step 6: App category: **Productivity**

Step 7: Tags: Notification manager, Delivery driver tools, Earnings tracker

4.3 App Signing (Google Play App Signing)

Google Play App Signing is mandatory for all new apps. When you upload your first AAB, Google will enroll your app in Play App Signing. This means Google manages your app signing key and generates optimized APKs from your AAB. Your original keystore is used as the 'upload key' for signing AABs you upload to Play Console. If you lose your upload key, you can request a reset from Google. However, if you opted out of Play App Signing and lost your signing key, your app cannot be updated. Always opt in to Play App Signing for safety.

5. Store Listing Content

5.1 App Title and Short Description

App Title (max 30 characters):

NotiFetch - Delivery Tracker

Short Description (max 80 characters):

Aggregate delivery notifications. Track orders and earnings across all platforms.

5.2 Full Description

NotiFetch is a personal notification aggregator designed specifically for delivery drivers and gig workers. It captures and organizes notifications from your delivery partner apps so you never miss an order, can track your earnings across platforms, and manage your workday efficiently.

WORKS WITH 55+ DELIVERY PLATFORMS: NotiFetch recognizes notifications from Swiggy, Zomato, Amazon Flex, Zepto, Blinkit, Uber, DoorDash, Rapido, Porter, Delhivery, Shadowfax, and many more delivery and driver apps across India and globally. See the full list in the app's Settings screen.

KEY FEATURES:

- Smart Notification Capture - Automatically captures order notifications from delivery partner apps using Android's NotificationListenerService
- Earnings Tracking - See your earnings across all platforms in one unified view
- Platform Customization - Rename any platform to your preferred name for quick identification
- Per-Platform Filters - Choose which delivery apps to monitor; turn off platforms you don't use
- Cross-Device Sync - Sync your notification history across devices with secure cloud backup
- Data Privacy First - Your data stays on your device. We never access personal messages, banking, or social media notifications
- 30-Day Auto-Delete - Captured notifications are automatically deleted after 30 days
- Data Export and Deletion - Export or delete all your data anytime (DPDP Act 2023 and GDPR compliant)
- Dark Mode - Easy on the eyes during late-night delivery shifts

5.3 Screenshots Requirements

Screenshot Type	Min	Max	Dimensions
Phone screenshots	4	8	16:9 or 9:16, min 320px
Tablet screenshots	0	8	16:9 or 9:16

Recommended screenshots to capture on a real device or emulator (do NOT show any platform logos or brand assets in screenshots for legal safety):

- Home screen with sample notifications (use generic names, not real brand names in screenshots)
- Notification detail view showing order information
- Settings screen showing platform customization feature
- Consent screen showing data privacy commitments
- Profile screen with data rights section visible
- Dark mode version of the home screen
- Search/filter functionality
- Platform rename dialog

5.4 Feature Graphic

The feature graphic is a 1024x500 PNG that appears at the top of your Play Store listing. It should showcase the app name 'NotiFetch' prominently with a tagline like 'All your delivery notifications in one place'. Use a clean design with the app's primary color scheme. Do not include any delivery platform logos or brand assets. Consider using a device mockup showing the app interface with

generic/placeholder data. The graphic should be visually clear and readable even at small sizes on mobile devices.

6. Data Safety and Content Rating

6.1 Google Play Data Safety Declarations

Google Play requires all apps to declare what user data they collect, how it is used, and whether it is shared. This is a critical compliance requirement that directly affects your app's visibility and trust. For NotiFetch, you must be transparent about the notification data the app reads. The Data Safety form is in Play Console > App Content > Data Safety. Here are the exact declarations you should make:

Data Type	Collected	Shared	Purpose	Encrypted	Deletable
App activity (notifications)	Yes	No	App functionality	Yes	Yes
App info and performance	Yes	No	Analytics	Yes	Yes
Device or other IDs	Yes	No	App functionality	Yes	Yes

Important: You must also answer 'Yes' to 'Does your app access notifications?' and explain that NotiFetch uses NotificationListenerService to read delivery partner app notifications only, with the user's explicit permission. This is a required disclosure for apps using this API. Be specific that the app only reads notifications from delivery/driver apps and never accesses personal messages, banking apps, or social media notifications. This transparency is critical for Google Play review approval.

6.2 IARC Content Rating

The content rating questionnaire determines the age rating for your app across different regions. For NotiFetch, answer the questionnaire as follows to receive the most favorable rating:

Violence: None - The app contains no violent content

Sexual Content: None - No sexual content of any kind

Language: None - No profanity or offensive language

Substance Use: None - No references to drugs, alcohol, or tobacco

User Interaction: Yes - Users can receive notifications (select 'Share info' as type)

Information Sharing: Yes - App sends notification data to user's own account for sync

Digital Goods Purchases: No - No in-app purchases (will add Razorpay later as separate update)

Simulated Gambling: None

Location: No - App does not access device location

Expected rating: PEGI 3 / Everyone (lowest possible). This is important because delivery drivers of all ages use gig platforms, and a restricted rating would significantly reduce your potential user base.

7. Legal Compliance URLs

Google Play requires a Privacy Policy URL for all apps, and your app includes a comprehensive legal framework. These pages are already deployed and publicly accessible on your Vercel hosting. Enter these URLs in the appropriate Play Console fields.

Document	URL	Play Console Field
Privacy Policy	https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/privacy	App Content > Privacy Policy
Terms of Service	https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/terms	Not required by Play, but recommended
Legal Hub	https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/legal	Reference only

The Privacy Policy covers India DPDP Act 2023, EU GDPR, CCPA, and Google Play Data Safety requirements. It includes sections on data collection, purpose limitation, data minimization, legal basis (GDPR Article 6), your rights (access, rectification, erasure, portability), data retention (30-day auto-delete), and grievance officer contact. The Terms of Service includes a critical 'No Affiliation' disclaimer (Section 3) and a 'Nominative Fair Use Notice' (Section 5) that protects against trademark claims from delivery platforms. These legal documents were drafted to satisfy all major privacy frameworks and Google Play's policy requirements.

8. Upload and Review Process

8.1 Upload the AAB

After completing all the above sections in Play Console, you are ready to upload your AAB. Navigate to Production > Create new release in Play Console. Upload the app-release.aab file from app/build/outputs/bundle/release/. Google Play will validate the bundle, show you the permissions it requests, and confirm the signing key. Review all the information carefully before submitting. Enter release notes for this version:

Release Notes (v2.1.0):

- Added platform name customization: rename any delivery platform to your preferred name
- Added comprehensive consent flow before data collection
- Added data export and deletion (DPDP Act 2023 and GDPR compliant)
- Added Privacy Policy and Terms of Service links in app

- Added per-platform notification filters
- Improved notification listener reliability
- Enhanced data safety with network security configuration

8.2 Review Timeline

Google Play reviews typically take 1-7 days for new apps. Apps that access notifications or use foreground services may undergo additional scrutiny and could take up to 14 days. During the review, Google will check your app for policy compliance, malware, data safety accuracy, and content rating alignment. You can check the review status in Play Console. If your app is rejected, Google will provide specific reasons that you must address before resubmitting.

8.3 Common Rejection Reasons for Notification Apps

Rejection Reason	How NotiFetch Addresses It
Missing privacy policy	Privacy Policy is live at /privacy and linked in Play Console
Unclear notification access purpose	ConsentScreen explains what is read and why before any collection
Missing data safety declarations	Section 6 of this guide provides exact declarations
Foreground service without proper type	Manifest declares foregroundServiceType="specialUse" with PROPERTY_SPECIAL_USE_FGS_SUBTYPE
Accessing data beyond stated purpose	Only delivery partner notifications are processed; personal messages are excluded
No data deletion mechanism	In-app Delete All Data feature + web dashboard export/delete
Misleading app description	Description clearly states it reads notifications, does not claim to be a delivery platform

9. Post-Submission Actions

9.1 Monitor Review Status

After submitting, monitor your Play Console dashboard for review updates. Google will send email notifications when the review status changes. Common statuses include: 'In review' (being examined), 'Ready to publish' (approved, waiting for you to publish), 'Published' (live on Play Store), and 'Rejected' (issues found, must fix and resubmit). Do not make changes to the store listing while the app is in review, as this can restart the review process.

9.2 Production Best Practices

- Set up Firebase Crashlytics to monitor crashes in production
- Enable Google Play's pre-launch reports for future versions
- Monitor user reviews and respond promptly to feedback
- Keep your Privacy Policy and Terms of Service updated
- Use staged rollout for future updates (start with 10% of users)
- Set up app signing key backup with Google Play App Signing
- Register a support email address for user inquiries
- Consider adding in-app feedback mechanism for bug reports

9.3 Future Update Checklist

For every future update, remember to: increment `versionCode` (must be higher than the previous release), update `versionName` appropriately, test the AAB on a real device before uploading, write clear release notes, and verify that any new permissions are declared in the Data Safety form. The `versionCode` must always be a positive integer that increases with each release. The current version is `versionCode=3`, `versionName=2.1.0`. Your next release should be `versionCode=4` at minimum.

10. Quick Reference

Item	Value
Application ID	com.notifetch.app
Version Code	3
Version Name	2.1.0
Min SDK	24 (Android 7.0)
Target SDK	35 (Android 15)
Compile SDK	35
Keystore	twakeystore.jks
Key Alias	notifetch
SHA-256 Fingerprint	81:97:95:57:6B:2F:1C:94:D2:7A:6B:63:E2:3C:7C:C7:D8:58:50:CB:CA:A1:E5:00:7A:23:BB:3B:44:DD:AB:FE
Privacy Policy URL	https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/privacy

Terms of Service URL	https://d2-liart-nine.vercel.app/terms
Play Store Category	Productivity
Content Rating	Everyone (PEGI 3)
App Signing	Google Play App Signing (opt-in)
GitHub Repository	github.com/Yashas-K-Gangatkar/d2